



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

ADVENT 2022

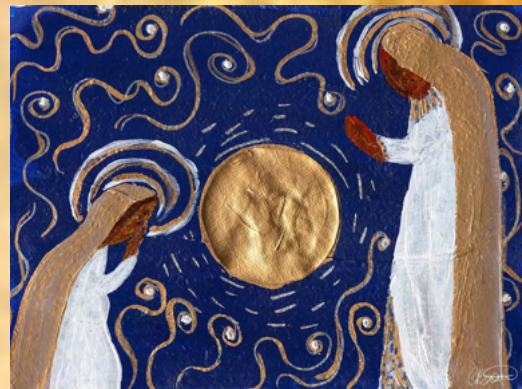
Advent Worship

Advent, the season of preparation for Christmas, begins on November 27. Our theme will be “Generation to Generation” and we’ll be utilizing images and devotional materials from *A Sanctified Art*.

We’ll offer our Christmas Pageant once again in person on Sunday, Dec. 11 at 4:00 p.m.

Three services on Christmas Eve, 4:00 p.m. and 10:00 p.m.. indoors, 6:00 p.m. outside.

Christmas Day worship at 10:00 a.m. with a lot of singing!



Mary’s Golden Annunciation & The Golden Cradle
Carmelle Beaugelin | A Sanctified Art LLC | sanctifiedart.org

★ Nov. 27—1st Sunday of Advent
“There’s Room for Every Story”
Matthew 1:1-17

★ Dec. 4—2nd Sunday of Advent
Communion
“God Meets Us In Our Fear”
Luke 1:26-38

★ Dec. 11—3rd Sunday of Advent
“We Can Choose A Better Way”
Matthew 1:18-25

★ Dec. 18—4th Sunday of Advent
“We See God In Each Other”
Luke 1:39-58

★ Dec. 24—Christmas Eve
♦ 4:00 Informal with flashlights
♦ 6:00 Outdoor service
♦ 10:00 Traditional Candlelight

★ Dec. 25—Christmas Day
One service at 10:00
John 1:1-14

★ Jan. 1—Epiphany
One service at 10:00—Communion
“Epiphanies”
Matthew 2:1-12

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United Women in Faith



United
Women
in Faith



Your UWF sponsors one meal a month at Simpson Shelter as they change locations. We served a beans-and-weenies hotdish on Oct. 26 thanks to Margaret Rawson's creativity. Servers included Margaret Rawson, Char and Craig Johnson, Kevin Korell and Scott Gruenhagen. THANKS THANKS THANKS The cost of the meal is covered with funds raised by the UWF. If you'd like to join us in serving or cooking, the future dates are Nov. 28 and Dec. 27; serving goes from 5:30-8:30 p.m. with a carpool from church. Please let Maureen Trepp know you'd like to help at 612-387-2520.



Your National UWF has been offering fascinating online webinars on many different topics important to the mission of the UWF (United Women in Faith) and easy to access and watch from home. Included have been discussions/presentations on national legislative issues including ending corporal punishment in schools, missing Native American women, and incarcerating youth as adults. There is an online monthly newsletter title "Connect" that you could connect to thru uwfaith.org and from that site you can find the list of books in the UWF Reading Program. Check it out!

Come on out again, you women! Another Women's Night Out is on Thursday, Dec. 8. We'll be meeting this time at Town Hall Lanes, 5019 34th Ave. So. from 4:00-7:00 or as late as you want to stay. Join us for part of the time or the whole evening. Let Maureen know you are coming, please.



Scenes from 2022 Holiday Bazaar



Newsletter Schedule

Since early spring, we have been trying a different thing with our newsletter. Rather than a monthly newsletter, we are trying to provide newsletters that cover a programming period. For those of you submitting information to go out in the newsletter, here is our planned schedule for the next two issues:

- Deadline Dec. 16, mailed Dec. 27
- Deadline February 3, mailed February 14.

And, if you miss a deadline, don't forget that the vast majority of our folks get the weekly e-news, and you can always put information in that as well. We do try to make the e-news shorter by having events that are 1-3 weeks away, so you are welcome to have a quick "save the date" article further out, but then provide information closer to the event.



Youth Halloween Party

Snow Policy

Our policy for cancellations due to snow is that for programmatic activities, if Minneapolis Public Schools has closed, then assume the church is also closed. However, now that we have zoom available, your event might easily move to zoom. If you are leading the event or meeting, please let all your participants know if you decide to change to an all zoom format. You may also always choose to hold your program or meeting in person, but it is up to you to contact all the participants and let them know that. If this is something like a big program or Wednesday night meals, please be sure to let Dean Ammerman (dean@kabloona.com) know for the website and Tanya Ketcham (communications@minnehaha.org) know for a Facebook posting. And, you can always check those places to see if an event is being held.



CHRISTMAS POINSETTIAS

It is Minnehaha tradition to decorate our sanctuary with poinsettias for the week of Christmas. If you would like to be part of this, complete the order form below and bring it to the church office (or drop it in an offering basket). The cost is \$14 per poinsettia (6.5" pot single red poinsettia). You may take your plant home after 4pm or 10pm Christmas Eve Service.

Orders should be turned in by December 9 at noon.

Name: _____

Phone: _____

Please dedicate this plant in: (select one) Honor Celebration Memory Other

of: _____



ORDER YOUR
POINSETTIAS

Children & Youth Calendar



Sunday School

10:15-11:00 am

Nov. 27: No Classes

Dec. 4: Large group song practice, individual classes practice for pageant & *Swords into Plowshares* lesson

Dec. 11: Large group song practice, individual classes practice for pageant & *Jews & Gentiles* lesson

Dec. 18: *John's Questions for Jesus* lesson

Dec. 25: No Classes



Photos from Youth outings to Dairy Queen and Minnehaha Falls, autumn scavenger hunt, & "deathball" (both pages)

All-Church Advent Wreath Making

Sunday, Nov. 27 from 10:15-11:00 am

All households are invited to make an Advent Wreath and then take home.

(There will be a variety of age-appropriate versions to choose for you household.)

Wednesday Night Dinner

5:30-6:15 pm

Suggested Cost: \$5/person; \$20/family; kids under 5 eat free

If you would like to cook a meal, please contact Beth Minehart at pbpminhart@gmail.com

If you can help with dishes/clean-up, please contact Jean Elliott at education@minnehaha.org

NOTE: No Wednesday Night Dinner on Nov. 23, Dec. 21, or Dec. 28

Middle School & High School Youth Groups

Sundays from 4:00-5:30 pm.

Nov. 27: No Youth Groups -Thanksgiving Weekend-

Dec. 4: Food Ministry Project

Dec. 11: No Youth Groups -Christmas Pageant-

Dec. 18: Christmas Party

Dec. 25: No Youth Groups -Merry Christmas!-

Jan. 1: No Youth Groups -Happy New Year!-

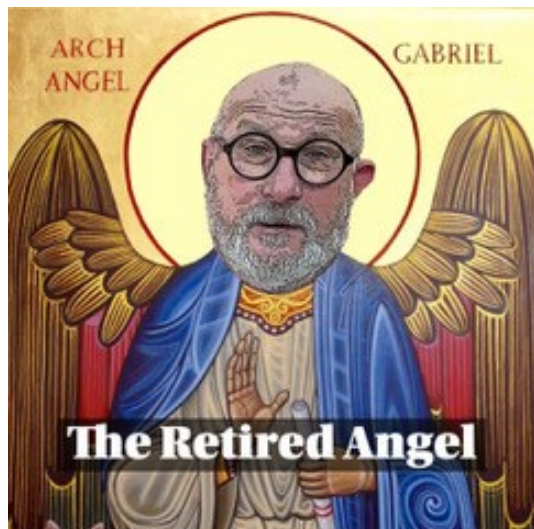


"The Retired Angel" Christmas Pageant

Sunday, Dec. 11 at 4:00 pm in the Sanctuary with Dinner following in Fellowship Hall

Note: Rehearsal is Wednesday, Dec. 7 from 6:15-7:30 pm

Children's Secret Workshop



Youth Orchestra

All middle and high school students who play a band or orchestra instrument are invited to join the Youth Orchestra or the Christmas Pageant.

Please let Jenny Ammerman at

jennyammerman@comcast.net know if you want to participate.

Rehearsals: Wednesday, Nov. 30 from 6:15-7:00pm in Middle School Youth Room and Sunday, Dec. 4 from 11:00-11:45am in Music Room 310.



Feeling a Little Blue for Christmas

Sure, there's lots to be joyful about as we approach Christmas, but the shorter days and colder temperatures don't leave everyone full of good cheer. Add in a feeling of frenzy from the rush of the season, and it already begins to feel a little overwhelming. Add in even more, a job loss or change, the loss of a loved one, a change in health, a strained friendship, a move, and it can begin to feel like we are out of sync with the joy being expressed at every turn.

You are invited to rest awhile in silence, in quiet music, and in the glow of candlelight as we observe our Blue Christmas Taizé service on December 9 at 7:00 p.m. Whether you need an opportunity to just sit still for a little bit, or you are looking for a way to acknowledge feelings of loss or depression, join with others for an hour of reflection and rest as we continue to find God's presence in the midst of wherever we are.



Christmas Eve

Please join us, and invite your friends and neighbors, for Christmas Eve services this year. We'll have two indoor services and an outdoor service.

4:00 – a child-friendly service featuring music with The Methodicals and flashlights in place of candles.

6:00 – a very informal outdoor service around our fire pit.

10:00 – a more traditional candlelight service with choir and organ.

Advent Devotionals and Calendars

Advent, the season of preparation for Christmas, begins on November 27. We are following a theme of "Generation to Generation" and have Advent calendars for families with children, and an Advent Devotional for every household. You can pick up either/both of these items at the church any Sunday. Let us know if you cannot make it to church and would like us to mail you a devotional and/or calendar.



Call for Musicians!

Calling all children, youth and adult musicians! We are making a concerted effort to involve more members in our music ministry, and are asking you to consider sharing your gifts during worship when it is convenient for you. We can be very flexible with dates, as well as what you play. You can choose to play or sing at one or both services, and if you have accompaniment needs, we can talk through that as well.

If interested, please contact Jean Elliott at education@minnehaha.org



ADVENT WREATH MAKING

**SUNDAY, NOV. 27
10:15-11:00 AM**

**ALL HOUSEHOLDS ARE INVITED TO
MAKE AND TAKE HOME A WREATH**

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

One-Service Sunday on Christmas Day

On December 25, Christmas Sunday, there will be no Sunday School, and we'll worship together at one service at 10:00. Join us for a festive morning of celebration with lots of singing!

Bethel Lutheran, Minnehaha United Methodist,
and St Peder's Lutheran Churches

Invite you to our
Thanksgiving Eve
WORSHIP SERVICE

Joint choir practices at 6:00 PM in the balcony. **November 23 7:00 PM** Bring friends and family!

4120 17th Ave South, Minneapolis, MN
Followed by a pie social

Thanksgiving Eve Worship

This year's ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve service will be at Bethel Lutheran Church, 4120 17th Ave. on Wednesday, Nov. 23 at 7:00 p.m. There will be a mass choir (which anyone is welcome to join) with a joint rehearsal prior to the worship service at 6:00. We'll have some time to meet each other and renew ongoing relationships afterwards, so if you can help out by bringing a pie to share with others, that would be great. Pies can be home-made or store-bought, and as simple or as complicated as you want. We look forward to seeing you the night before Thanksgiving as we come to God with gratitude for all that God has given us.

New and Improved Gym is Ready to Use

If you haven't viewed the gym lately, take a look! We replaced the south wall, installed a Sport Court floor, added an air handling system, and repainted everything. So now it's a real gym for everyone to enjoy, thanks to recent member bequests, memorials, and rental contracts.

Use It

As a member of the church, you can use the gym for your personal enjoyment. There are official lines on the floor for pickleball, and not-so-official lines for volleyball and basketball. Basketballs and volleyballs are stored in the middle gym closet along with the volleyball net. Pickleball paddles, balls, and the net are available on request.

Make a Reservation

To reserve time in the gym, just fill out a Facility Use Application form, which is on the church website. (Go to the black bar at the top of the Home Page and select: BLDG. USE > WORK ORDERS, BLDG. & KITCHEN, and look for the section on Facility Use Application.) Then submit your request to the church office for approval. This will make sure your time slot is put on the church calendar and doesn't interfere with church activities or with others who signed up to use the gym.

Gym Rules & Liability Waivers

Gym use rules can be found on the gym door and on the church website. Also, due to insurance concerns, you'll need to fill out a Liability Release Waiver. Look for the waivers in the hallway before you enter the gym, as well as on the church website. (Go to the black bar at the top of the Home Page and select: FORMS > GYM RULES & LIABILITY WAIVER.). There's a \$20 an hour fee when four or more people use the gym for family-friendly games. The gym is also available for rent to outside people and groups.

Questions?

If you have questions, please contact anyone on the Rental Committee: Renee Beymer, Dean Ammerman, Troy Reichard, and Kim Kanuit. (rentals@minnehaha.org)



Toy Drive Donations Needed

During the 4 Tuesdays before Christmas, Food Shelf Parents are able to select toys for their children, ranging from babies to teenagers. Parents may choose a toy (ranging from baby toys to dolls to hot wheels to table foosball to hair dryers and clock radios), a stocking stuffer, and a hat or gloves for each of their children. We also provide gift bags and wrapping paper. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha. *Every year, parents respond with "Thank you, thank you, thank you!" and "Oh my gosh, these present are so nice!" and "Can I really get a hat and gloves for each of my children?"*

There are three ways you can help with this mission:

- ★ Buy toys, hats, and gloves— As our office hours are limited a great time to drop off toys is during MinneHarvest. To arrange another drop off time contact Renee Beymer (janos3@juno.com)
- ★ Write a check to the church (put Toys in the memo line) or give through our Donate button on the website and designate it for Christmas Toys.

With your help Good Things will, indeed, continue to Happen Here.



Grand Piano Update

We Did It!

Thanks to the generous donations from our congregation and a gift from the Memorials fund, our new Kawai baby grand piano is fully paid for! Minnehaha will be able to enjoy its beautiful music for years to come. Thank you to everyone who contributed. Jenny Ammerman



Youth Groups went to Target and shopped for Christmas gifts for teens.

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month (with exceptions in November and December for the holidays – we serve the 3rd Saturday on those months). You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! We'll be offering food on November 19 and December 17.

Food Shelf

To supplement the food we distribute at the Food Shelf, several neighboring churches have participated in a monthly drive for personal items and items in short supply in the food shelf. Throughout the month of November, we will be collecting feminine Hygiene products. In December, we will be collecting cooking oil. Please drop donations in the round bin labeled for the food shelf.

Fun and Fitness – 42nd Year Reunion

On Thursday, September 15, “Fun and Fitness” members “past and present” met to celebrate 42 years of gathering to exercise and support each other. Shirley Arms hosted the event at her home. Over twenty attended.

Shirley says that in 1980, our church had a “Listen to the Congregation” meeting for input on what was working and what they would like to see added. One request was an exercise group. With the help of the “Ok Gang” and older kids, she started “Fun and Fitness”.

“Fun and Fitness” has over the years had members as old as 103 and as young as preschool age who tagged along with their grandparents. The group has become an ecumenical group with people attending from neighborhood churches, the general community, and by word of mouth. Serving more than just Minnehaha members!

Many years ago, Shirley audio taped the exercise routine so that when she wasn’t there, they had the CD to use in her place. Now they use it regularly for a familiar routine.

While most of the exercisers are in their 70’s and 80’s now, “Keep moving to stay young” is their motto. Even if they can’t do all the exercises, many just move in place. Each do what they can.

Not only does this group benefit from weekly exercise and support, they generously donate to our Minnehaha Food Shelf. Collecting donations as a way to repay Minnehaha for its support of their “Fun and Fitness” group.

If you would like to join this exercise group, feel free to just show up at any time. They meet every Tuesday and Thursday mornings from 9:00 to 10:00 am in Room 302/304. All are welcome. Contact Shirley Arms or Conrad Larson, if you would like more information.





Generations

Generation to Generation is our theme for Advent. It comes from Luke 1:50 – Mary is singing her song of protest and praise, and states that God’s mercy is for all those who fear God, from generation to generation. Despite the challenges and vulnerability she faced, Mary could glimpse the scale and scope of the good news she was part of bringing forth. This good news transcends time and space – it was and is bigger than just her. Christ is coming for collective liberation: God’s redemption is at work for years to come. Therefore, the promise is meant to be lived out and passed on from generation to

generation (from Sanctified Art).

This good news transcends time and space - it was and is bigger than just her.

As we fret about inflation, illness, jobs, threats to our democracy, it is important to remember that God is at work with us. And, by being at work with us, we have space for both protest and praise. We will celebrate this Advent and Christmas season, despite the headlines. Maybe it’s better to say that there is

much in our world worth celebrating, and we will join in the praise, even as we protest where necessary. Advent and Christmas aren’t an exception from the rest of our lives, they are the key to how we live. Join with Mary in looking around at where there is potential, where there is a need for a word of justice, and where we can simply sing praise for a starry sky, a miraculous birth, a world clearly in the hands of God.

In Joy,
Becky



Wilderness Blossom

Lauren Wright Pittman | A Sanctified Art LLC | sanctifiedart.org



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